

Instant Dialogue

bass clarinet

Neil Thornock

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for solo bass clarinet

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Performance notes:

1. The score is notated on two staves in order to visually communicate the interplay of contrasts. Lines connecting the events between staves indicate the relationship of events. A relationship of interruption and resumption between each of the voices (rather than orderly progression) is to be attained primarily by means of duration (a "cutting short" of the interrupted rhythm). The performer should maximize the difference between the two lines in terms of character, tempo, timbre, dynamic, articulation, etc., maintaining general consistency within each line. Thick lines drawn between the staves indicate structural divisions (phrases).

2. The "broken beaming" peculiar to the bottom staff indicates an uneven, irregular pulse.

3. Notehead shapes refer to the following methods of note production:

■ Hard, biting tone, shrill in the upper register.

◇ Sotto voce.

□ Breath tone.

4. Length of pauses are approximately as follows:

▮ Very long, 7"

▮ Long, 5"

⤿ Moderate, 3"

” Short, 1"

• Very short, .5"

5. ———> Indicates a gradual progression from the one method of note production to the other.

6. Trills begin on the upper auxilliary a whole step higher than the trilled note (paranetical pitches indicate the auxilliary).

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fast, vigorous
(tempo rubato ad lib.)

bass clarinet

ff *pp* *fff* *p* fl. z.

This system contains two staves. The upper staff begins with a fortissimo (ff) dynamic, followed by a piano (p) section, and then a fortississimo (fff) section marked 'fl. z.'. The lower staff starts with a pianissimo (pp) dynamic and features a crescendo leading into the fff section.

mp *f* *mf* *ff* *sfz* 5:4 3:2 5:4 5:4

This system contains two staves. The upper staff includes a series of triplets and is marked with dynamics *mp*, *f*, *mf*, *ff*, and *sfz*. It also features time signature changes indicated by brackets: 5:4, 3:2, 5:4, and 5:4. The lower staff has a crescendo leading to the *sfz* dynamic.

mp *f* *f* *ff* fl. z. *pp*

This system contains two staves. The upper staff has a crescendo from *mp* to *f*, followed by a section marked *f* and *ff* with the marking 'fl. z.'. The lower staff begins with a pianissimo (pp) dynamic and has a crescendo.

andante misterioso

pp *p*

This system contains a single staff with a melody starting at a pianissimo (pp) dynamic and ending at a piano (p) dynamic.

pp *f*

This system contains a single staff. It begins with a pianissimo (pp) dynamic and ends with a fortissimo (f) dynamic.

mf *f* *pp*

This system contains a single staff. It starts with a mezzo-forte (mf) dynamic, followed by a fortissimo (f) dynamic, and ends with a pianissimo (pp) dynamic.

ppp *pp* *mp* *mf* *ppp* *f*

quasi gliss. subito!

* Proceed without pause.

ppp *pp*

faster

mp *f* *ppp* *f* *fff* *pp*

quasi gliss. subito! gliss. slower (short)

pp *ppp* *pp*

a tempo

ppp *ff*

furioso fl. z.

Musical notation for a piano piece, featuring seven systems of staves. The notation includes various musical symbols such as notes, rests, and dynamic markings.

Dynamics and articulation markings include:

- f* (forte)
- ff* (fortissimo)
- pp* (pianissimo)
- fff* (fortississimo)
- mf* (mezzo-forte)
- mp* (mezzo-piano)
- p* (piano)
- ppp* (pianississimo)

Tempo and performance markings include:

- 5:4* (time signature)
- 6:4* (time signature)
- slowly*
- Very slowly*
- accel.* (accelerando)
- rit.* (ritardando)

A performance instruction is provided:

- * If necessary, *diminuendo al niente* to make a small break and breathe here. Reenter imperceptibly.

The notation concludes with a final system of staves, including a key signature change to one flat and a final dynamic marking of *ppp*.